Sous Vide Ribs

Main dishes | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: grinder, sous-vide bath, food-safe bags, ice bath, saucepan, and oven. Plan ahead: refrigerate seasoned ribs 4-12 hours; cook 36 hours at 145°F or 12 hours at 165°F. Oven finish: about 40 minutes at 300°F.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Dry rub; reserve 3 Tbsp

Bowl B - Sauce base

Dry rub:

- [ ] 1/3 cup paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/3 cup dark brown sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 cup kosher salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp whole yellow mustard seed [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp garlic powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp dried oregano [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp whole coriander seed [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp red pepper flakes [Bowl A]

Sauce and ribs:

- [ ] 1 medium yellow onion, grated [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 1/2 cups ketchup [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp spicy brown mustard [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/3 cup dark molasses [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup Worcestershire sauce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/4 cup apple cider vinegar [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 1/2 tsp liquid hickory smoke
- [ ] 2 racks St. Louis-cut pork ribs

1. Prepare rub and ribs

1. Remove the membrane from 2 racks St. Louis-cut pork ribs. Cut each rack into portions containing 3-4 ribs.

2. Grind together 1/3 cup paprika, 1/3 cup dark brown sugar, 1/4 cup kosher salt, 2 Tbsp whole yellow mustard seed, 1 tsp black pepper, 2 Tbsp garlic powder, 1 Tbsp dried oregano, 1 Tbsp whole coriander seed, and 1 tsp red pepper flakes.

3. Reserve 3 Tbsp dry rub for the sauce (or for a dry-style finish). Season ribs generously with the rest.

4. Bag rib portions with about 4 drops liquid hickory smoke per bag, taken from the total 1 1/2 tsp. Seal and refrigerate 4-12 hours.

2. Sous vide and chill

1. For a meatier texture, cook at 145°F for 36 hours. For a more traditional barbecue texture, cook at 165°F for 12 hours.

2. Chill the cooked ribs in ice water.

3. Make sauce

1. Simmer the reserved 3 Tbsp rub with 1 grated medium yellow onion, 1 1/2 cups ketchup, 2 Tbsp spicy brown mustard, 1/3 cup dark molasses, 1/4 cup Worcestershire sauce, 1/4 cup apple cider vinegar, and the liquid smoke remaining from the original 1 1/2 tsp. Simmer about 20 minutes.

4. Finish in the oven

1. Heat the oven to 300°F. Pat the ribs dry and heat in the oven about 20 minutes.

2. Brush with some prepared sauce and bake 10 minutes. Brush again and bake another 10 minutes, until sticky.

3. Add a final coat of sauce to serve.

Notes

Dry-style option: omit the sauce-making stage. Coat the cooked ribs with the reserved 3 Tbsp dry rub before finishing.

For dry-style ribs, skip the sauce and coat the cooked ribs with the reserved dry rub before finishing.